

This shows that U.S. is becoming more firm in supporting the position of Taiwan.

Biden Administration has made some changes in posture.

The indication is greater assurance for the security.

★ Current State of India - Taiwan Relation :-

Since 2010, India has stopped overtly mentioning "One China Policy" in joint declarations with China. If on one hand, India - U.S. relations are getting closer, India - China relations are becoming more and more abnormal.

In the past even, China - Taiwan relations were not as bad b/c :-

The then ruling Party of Taiwan was more integrationist. There has been China - Taiwan FTA.

★ Why Relations have Changed ?-

B/c of US - China Tensions Taiwan has become escape Goat.

The Present ruling Party of Taiwan is Ultra-nationalist.

China's strategy is to wait till 2024 when Elections will take place in Taiwan.

Hence, officially China mentions, 2027 but Some ^{Political} Pandits Predicts it can be earlier i.e. 2025.

At present India - Taiwan Relations have improved b/c of opening up of Indian - Economy. Taiwan has announced its New South bound Policy. In South bound policy to improve relations with Southern neighbours like - India, Australia,

Recently, India and Taiwan have entered into an Agreement where Taiwan will help in developing India's capabilities in Manufacturing Semi-Conductors.

Taiwan wants to increase its security and India has become Net Security Provider. USA wants to shift its burden to pass the buck on India.

* India in South China Sea :-

i) 2013 — Annual Report of MEA clearly mentions —

that India's security is linked to South China Sea. India has huge interest in maintaining Freedom of navigation. Like - US, India does not have any territorial claims yet India has interest in, Open Seas.

ii) 2010 :- China declared South China Sea as a core area of China's National interest at par with Tibet & Taiwan.

iii) 2011 :- People Liberation Army Navy plan

Challenged the presence of INS - Arunwat. Thus, restricting Freedom of navigation.

China also objected ONACVL Plans for joint explorations of oil & Gas with Vietnam.

2012 :- USA started talking about pivot to Asia Policy & India's role in the Policy.

2013 :- China launched BRI with 2 Components, -

- a) land Components - known as Silk road Economic belt.
- b) Maritime Component - i.e. Maritime Silk Road.

Thus, China's ambitions gone beyond South China Sea, expanded into Indian Ocean to reach the Source of Africa & West Asia.

Earlier US administration had suggested in its report -

"Energy Futures in Asia" where it has mentioned that China has a policy of Containment of India by building Naval Ports, outposts in Indian Ocean w/c they termed as "String of Pearls Policy".

What is the difference b/w in Maritime Silk Route (MSR) & String of Pearls Policy?

MSR - It is more ambitious policy. so called String of Pearls, as explained by China was to protect its SLOC (Sea Lines of Communication) from Piracy & other threats. It also justified its actions as providing "Public Good".
It means ensuring the Safe Seas.

~~It means~~

However, Maritime Silk Route is not limited to the Ocean.
It is making in roads in Domestic context of the State.

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i) In Economic sense creating China led Economic Order, integrating the Economics with Chinese Economy.

It is a massive infrastructure Development Programme.

ii) Thus, ^{it is} the Geo-Economic initiative whereas String of Pearls is the Geo-Political initiative.

Political sense -

i) China is not just exporting Goods, China is also exporting Chinese Model of Governance. w/c Xi-XingPing called as Socialism with Chinese Characteristics. w/c west calls as Exporting Authoritarianism.

Thus, US-China rivalry is not just Geo-Economic or Geo-Political It is also developing ideological dimensions.

* 2014:- P.M. Modi launched Neighbourhood First Policy.

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improving relations with immediate neighbours (South Asia), to manage China Challenge. He became the 1st P.M. of India after a long gap, since assassination of Rajeev Gandhi to visit Sri Lanka.

He also visited Nepal, gave message to move from "Yodha to Buddha", from Shastra to Shastra, advised to Nepal to come up

with the Constitution w/c should appear like -

Bouquet of Flowers of different colour.

w.r.t Bhutan, he consolidated the relations.

Not only these countries, there has been attempts to improve relations with Pakistan.

P.M. Modi ignored the Protocol displayed Personal diplomacy to create atmosphere of Peace in South Asia. The most successful Chapter of Neighbourhood 1st Policy has been with Bangladesh, resolution of border dispute, exchange of enclaves.

However, neighbourhood 1st Policy had limited success b/c China has stepped up its presence in the Region.

i) China would never allow Pakistan to normalise relations with India.

Hence, there has been continuous terrorist attack -

Uri & Pulwama & since then there is no normalisation of the Relation. The only achievement is agreement to observe Ceasefire on LOC

2014 onwards:- India has stepped up its ambitions:-

a) launched act its Policy. with strong strategic content. to strengthen the Defence Partnership with China's neighbours.

b) In 2015, From Mauritius India has launched its Programme SAGAR based on P.M. Modi's signature idea - **Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas**, w/c is act variation with China's middle kingdom complex.

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A Sino-centric world order.

What is its speciality ?

- A Hierarchical view., this is how China sees the world.

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What was the occasion when SAGAR came ? -

India presented 1st - India built Warship to Mauritius, Commissioning of Kora Class Corvette Baracuda.

From Port. Louis itself P.M. Modi gave his vision w/c is now seen as the "Component of India's Indo-Pacific Vision." The idea was to develop -

- i) Climate of Trust and transparency.
- ii) Respect for international maritime rules & norms by all countries.
- iii) Sensitivity to each-others interest.
- iv) Peaceful Resolution of disputes. increased in Maritime Co-operation

* these Five are the vision for South China Sea.

P.M. Modi gave Vision for SAGAR ! -

Advancing Co-operation in the region to use our capabilities for the benefit of all in our common maritime home.

* Modi visited Seychelles in 2015 ! -

From where he launched his initiative of "Blue Economy."

2015:- Indian Navy brought its new Maritime Doctrine.

Title — Ensuring Safe Sea — assuming the Role of net Security Provider.

2016:- "14th Asian — India Summit"

— India for the 1st time mentioned Peace in Maritime Sphere as Area of Co-operation with Asian.

2017:- Minister of State for Foreign Affairs — V.K. Singh, in R.S. expressed India's security and Prosperity is linked to South China Sea as 55% of India's trade is through South China Sea.

2018:- Shangri-la Dialogue — where P.M. Modi held that the creed we follow in the East will also ^{be} followed more vigorously through Act East.

He emphasised on :-

- i) Freedom of Navigation.
- ii) Unimpeded Commerce.
- iii) Peaceful Settlements of disputes.

2019!- 17th Summit with Asean (Virtual Summit)"

— 1st time India expressed concerns over recent development in South China Sea eroding trust, and emphasised on increasing transparency, Freedom of Navigation

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2020!- 1st Summit of QUAD took place. Thus, besides working with Asean Countries, Island States in Indian Ocean, India started working with major powers in the Region to balance China's Power.

Thus, India officially embraced the vision of Free and Open Indo-Pacific at the highest level, in wake of Chinese Aggressive Postures in the Region.

• Vision of QUAD!-

It is also to maintain Freedom of Navigation, Rule based Order, to protect & promote democratic value.

• 2 Major initiative taken under QUAD are!-

i) Strengthening Maritime Domain awareness.

ii) Indo-Pacific Economic Framework. —

— Both formally launched in Tokyo Summit 2022.

The Summit saw vision taking Concrete Shape. QUAD Summit establish 6 working Groups.

Initiatives!-

a) Covid 19 — Health Security.

b) Climate Change

c) Infrastructure

d) Emerging Technology

e) Cyber Security

f) Co-operation in Space.

Biden Administration has released —

i) Indo Pacific Strategy (Feb 2022) & National Security Strategy (2022 Oct).

a) In Indo-Pacific Strategy it has clearly mentioned supporting India's rise and leadership as a part of Action Plan.

b) In National Security Strategy Russia as a threat to Free & Open International System, China is the only Competitor with both intent and Capacity to reshape the Order.

c) India as a Strategic Partner.

Since US is strong in Pacific, India has to rely on US for protection of its interest in South China Sea and Greater Convergence is Emerging b/w the two.

India has consolidated its Strategic Partnership with all US allies in the Pacific.

There is a possibility of Emergence of QUAD + initiative.

QUAD Plus Countries! —

i) South Korea.

ii) Vietnam.

iii) New Zealand.

India has also not opposed the formation of AUKUS. Though ASEAN Countries are concerned with the Nuclear Arms race in the Region. AUKUS is of huge significance even for India as it strengthens Deterrence against China.

India has abstain from Voting on the resolution sponsored by Russia and China at IAEA, Challenging AUKUS as violation of NPT Norms.

What are other initiative of India w.r.t China's Maritime mis-adventures ?-

On 14th Nov 2019, External Affairs Minister mentioned -

- i) A changing world is more actionable for those who don't want to be left behind.
- ii) Ravindra Nath Tagore declared that we can't cross the sea merely by standing and ~~standing~~ staring at water.
- iii) For a beginning, it requires thinking that keeps up with times.
- iv) Clearly defined next steps and determined pursuit of the steps thereafter.

We can see that today there is a better appreciation of India's Maritime Geography and SAGAR Doctrine.

Ministry of External Affairs has launched "Indo-Pacific Ocean Initiative in 2019" integrating IORA + ASEAN + QUAD.

In 2020, Oceania division was created to focus on from Pacific Islands to Andaman Sea.

In 2019, P.M. Modi launched Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative at East Asia Int Summit in Bangkok to ensure safety, security & stability Maritime Domain. It is built on the pillars of :-

i) Act East and Act West.

A/c to S. Jayshankar, there are 7 Pillars of India's Maritime Sphere -

- a) Maritime Security.
- b) Ecology & Resources.
- c) Capacity building Information Sharing.
- d) Connectivity.
- e) Disaster Management.
- f) Trade & Transport.
- g) Sci, Technology & Academic initiative.

* China in Indian Ocean :-

- China has developed two Ocean Strategy :-
 - i) Pacific — Core in South China Sea.
Core is Taiwan.
- China has anti-Access Area Denial Strategy.
- China has more active developed ballistic missile programme.
- China is fast developing & installing :-
 - a) Short Range Missile.
 - b) ICBM
 - c) Dong Feng - 5. — capable of reaching US.

China is also developing MIRV (Multiple Independently Retargetable Vehicles).

Main Strategy is Militarisation here.

In Pacific, AUKUS is to act as a deterrence. India and other navies of QUAD are trying to establish the balance.

* Chinese activity in Indian Ocean!:-

• Soft landing - (Infrastructure Project, loans, Capacity building, etc.)

At the same time, China has established its 1st Naval port in horn of Africa.

China has plan for regular deployment of its aircraft carrier in Indian Ocean.

China has launched some developmental initiative — China has established "Indian Ocean Region Forum". It is organised by China's top developmental trade Agency CIDCA.

i) Marine Disaster prevention & mitigation.

ii) Sustainable development of Marine Resources.

iii) Renewable Energy.

iv) Tourism.

China is increasing its presence in the name of R&D. China has recently announced 19 Mandarin names for CBET features.

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Presently, China aims at understanding Indian Ocean so that it can enter w/o getting noticed.

Presently, China uses • Malakka Strait — w/c is not very deep. Therefore, sub marine has to navigate on surface.

- Sunda Strait — w/c is very shallow.
- Lombok Strait — w/c is deep. China is trying to understand "Om bai wetan Straits" of Indonesia.

* Island Development Agency for Andaman & Nicobar Island & also for Lakshadweep.

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Surf this.....